

Negotiations

A Deeper Dive Into The Art Of
Negotiating A Scene



What This Class Will Teach You

- Negotiations: What they are, and how they do.
- Key Points to always cover during negotiations.
- Some other useful bits to cover in negotiations.
- How to navigate compromises.

The Anatomy of a Scene

When two kinksters get together to engage in kink, it's called a **Scene**. There are three phases to having a scene with someone:

- Negotiations
- The Scene Itself
- Aftercare

This class will be focusing on the Negotiations phase of a scene.

Negotiations: What They Are, And How They Do

- When two kinksters get together to have a scene, they first **negotiate** what they'd like to experience in said scene.
 - They each propose what they want to do, and if necessary, they negotiate a compromise so that their interests are in alignment.
- Many points should be covered during negotiations so that all participants know what they're getting themselves into.
- Negotiations can also help for each participant to get a read on what their prospective play partner's vibes feel like, as it's ideal that there be some good chemistry between play partners.
- If the proposed activities don't perfectly align with each participant's interests and/or needs, then some further discussions and/or compromises can be made to ensure that everyone gets what they want out of the scene.
- It's also during this time that everyone specifies what their aftercare requirements are, if any.
- If neither participant can come to an agreement on how to carry out the scene, then perhaps they're not meant to be play partners. There's absolutely nothing wrong with that.
- One should never feel shame for not being able to work out negotiations with a prospective play partner.



Negotiations: What They Are, And How They Do

Some things to consider before beginning negotiations with a prospective play partner:

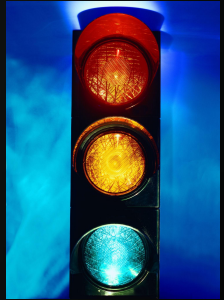
- Make sure that you're in a clear state of mind before beginning negotiations.
 - Trying to negotiate a scene while mentally compromised (i.e. tired, inebriated, under the influence of drugs, etc.) is a recipe for disaster, and thus should be avoided at all costs.
- Have a plan on what kinds of activities you'd like to get involved with before approaching a prospective play partner.
 - It's never a good look to approach someone and say "I want to play with you" but then not having an answer when they ask what specifically you'd like to do.
 - Knowing what you want when you begin negotiations will give your play partner the sense that you know yourself well enough to confidently negotiate a scene with them.
- Be sure to know what your personal limits are, and inform your prospective play partner of those limitations during negotiations.
 - This can also include things like hard limits, personal triggers to avoid, medical conditions that could affect the outcome of the scene, etc.
- Don't be afraid to decline from the scene if things don't feel right for whatever reason.
 - Likewise, don't take it personally if your prospective play partner declines from the scene, as well.



Key Points To Always Cover In Negotiations

General Points

- Specify what it is that you're looking to do with your prospective play partner during this scene.
 - This is also a good time to specify what you don't want to do with your play partner.
- Specify what your safewords are, and make sure to define what each safeword means to you.
- Inform your play partner of your soft limits and hard limits.
 - Soft Limits are activities that you'll only engage in under specific circumstances.
 - Hard Limits are activities that you never engage in under any circumstances.
- If you have any medical conditions that may interfere or otherwise become relevant during the proposed scene, you should absolutely mention them.



Key Points To Always Cover In Negotiations

Aftercare Needs

- It's important that you specify your aftercare needs BEFORE engaging in your scene so that your play partner knows what they need to provide to you once the scene is finished.
 - Do you need cuddles, or do you prefer to be left untouched?
 - Do you prefer to talk after a scene? If so, then what do you prefer to discuss at that time?
 - It's always a good idea to make sure that you have water with you, and a snack certainly wouldn't hurt to ensure that your sugar levels stay up.
- Make sure that you know what your aftercare needs are beforehand, as it'll help your play partner to provide you with the appropriate support once your scene is finished.
- If you have any particular requirements for your aftercare, it helps if you're capable of providing some of those requirements for your play partner to use.
 - Ex. If you have a preference for any particular snacks to eat during aftercare, or perhaps if you have a favored blanket that you like to wrap yourself in, then it'd be a good idea to bring those with you.
- Be sure to inform your play partner of how long your aftercare usually runs for so that they can ensure that they set enough time aside to address your needs.
- It's always a good idea to ask if it's alright to follow up with your play partner on the following day to ensure that they're still in a good headspace and that they're recovering well.
- Make sure to ask your play partner for what their aftercare needs are, as well!



Some Other Useful Bits To Cover During Negotiations

It also helps to feel out what your play partner is looking to get out of having a scene with you, specifically. This will also help you to get a read on whether or not you two have good chemistry together.

Some questions that help in this regard are as follows:

- What is it that you're seeking to experience in this scene with me?
- What draws you to want to share this experience with me?
- I like to check in with my play partners mid-scene to ensure that they're alright. Are you alright with this?
- What does it look like when I'm doing something wrong, and thus should change the course of the scene to get back on track?
- What does it look like when I'm doing something right, and thus should stay on the path that we're currently on because you're enjoying yourself?



How To Navigate Compromises

Sometimes what you're looking for may not line up exactly with what your prospective play partner is looking for. Just because things don't align perfectly doesn't mean that all is lost, however. Discussing things further can help to reach a compromise that lets everyone get something that they want out of the scene.

- Be sure to clearly communicate if something that your play partner is looking for isn't something that you're interested in.
 - This is especially important if a particular activity encroaches upon your hard limits.
- If you are willing to compromise, then be sure to specify where your personal boundaries are so that things don't cross over your boundaries accidentally.
- Ask lots of questions so that you can get an understanding of where your play partner is coming from, as well as what they're looking to get out of a scene with you.
- Be as reasonable as you are willing to be about a particular point that requires compromising, but don't become a doormat in the process.
 - Don't let your prospective play partner walk all over you just because you want to be a people pleaser.
- Stand firmly by your limits, and hold your prospective play partner to the standards that you hold yourself to.
 - Remember - you are solely responsible for taking care of yourself, so don't be a push-over when looking out for your best interests.



What If Things Just Don't Work Out?

- If things just aren't working out between you two, then it may be that this scene isn't a good idea for you two to engage in. And that's okay.
- This may be due to any reason, whether it be a legitimate reason or simply just a "gut instinct."
- It's best to strive for being as graceful about such scenarios when appropriate.
 - Politeness can get you far in most social situations, but this is not a hard rule. Read the situation and act accordingly.
- If your prospective play partner responds with trying to pressure you into the scene despite your lack of interest, don't buckle to peer pressure. State your boundaries and demand that they be respected.
 - If this doesn't resolve the conflict, then it's best to remove yourself from the situation and report the incident to the nearest event staffer.



Negotiations & Consent Forms

Forms such as what's shown on the right can be helpful in streamlining the negotiation process. However, as this form points out this does **not** replace the conversation that should happen during negotiations.

Be sure to have additional information to better explain the specifics of how you filled out your form. Also, be ready to ask your prospective play partner about what the information on their form means.

Tonight, I want...! My name is _____
Circle things you know you want. playing with _____
Cross out things you know you don't want (hard/soft limits for this scene).

I want to be a... and I want...	Top	Bottom	Switch
Impact Play	Stingy Thuddy	Heavy Light Canes	Flogging Whips Paddles Spanking
Bondage	Rope Leather/Cuffs Mental	Restrictive Decorative Cages	Suspension Collar/Lead Blindfolds Hoods
Sensation Play	Tickling Pressure Points Mind Fucks	Hair Pulling Playing with Hair Human Furniture	Scratching Electricity Exhibitionism
And...			Biting Licking Sensory Deprivation Edge Play
Intimacy and Sex	Cuddling Kissing Fluid Exchange Dirty Talk	Croping Open Mouth Kissing Hands on Genitals Condoms / Dental Dams	Penetration... Orgasms Giving Oral Sex Receiving Oral Sex Fingers Penis Toys Oral Vaginal Anal
I want to feel...	Serious Playful Erotic	Dominant Submissive Platonic	Masochistic Sadistic Energetic Cathartic Beautiful Peaceful Overwhelmed Degraded
Safewords	Plain Language	Red/Yellow/Green Stoplight System	"Safeword" Non-Verbal (Discuss)
Marks	None	For Today	For the Week For the Year Forever
Aftercare	0-5 minutes Water	5-15 mins Snack	15-60 mins Cuddling Conversation Socialize

You should know about my...
Partners: _____ Triggers: _____

Medical Conditions: _____
Injuries: _____
STI status: _____
Allergies: _____

Please show on the doll where you **do not want** to be touched:
www.dollhouse.com/consent/consentform
updated 9/25/15
www.dollhouse.com/consent/consentform



There are no right or wrong answers.
This is what you want, but you don't always get what you want.
Answer honestly, then talk to your play partner.
This sheet still requires conversation.
Be cautious of trying new things with new partners.
Don't feel bad about changing your mind after talking to your partner, but negotiate before you start to play.
It is safer to remove activities during a scene than to add play you didn't agree to beforehand.

Remember this phrase:
"What do you mean by _____?"

In Conclusion...

Negotiations are an important first step in making a scene happen. Stating our expectations, needs, and desires to one another is how we work together to align our interests and make memorable scenes into realities that we experience with our trusted play partners.

As is always the case, honesty and open communication is what allows for the exploration of our beloved kinks. So be open and honest with one another, and see where things will take you both!